

GOVERNMENT OF CANADA -- ITSG-33 IT SECURITY RISK MANAGEMENT

System Characterization and Assessment Scope

Veridia Integrated Project and Operations Platform (VIPOP)

Veridia Systems Group Inc.

Ottawa, Ontario | Federal IT Professional Services and Managed Services | Secret FSC

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System Being Assessed	Veridia Integrated Project and Operations Platform (VIPOP)
System Categorization	Medium -- Protected B Confidentiality, Medium Integrity, Low Availability
Regulatory Reference	ITSG-33 IT Security Risk Management: A Lifecycle Approach (CCCS, 2012 updated 2020)
Business Driver	DND contract renewal in 8 months requiring demonstrated ITSG-33 compliance
Related Documents	VS-ITSG-002 Gap Analysis Spreadsheet, VS-ITSG-003 Security Assessment Report

1. Purpose and Context

This document establishes the foundation for the ITSG-33 security assessment of the Veridia Integrated Project and Operations Platform (VIPOP), Veridia Systems Group Inc.'s primary information system for managing Government of Canada client engagements. It defines the organization and system being assessed, establishes the formal security categorization of VIPOP under the ITSG-33 framework, defines the authorization boundary, and specifies the scope and methodology of the assessment.

This document is the first deliverable in Veridia's ITSG-33 assessment series. It must be read before the Gap Analysis Spreadsheet (VS-ITSG-002) or the Security Assessment Report (VS-ITSG-003) because the system categorization and authorization boundary defined here determine which controls are assessed and how findings are interpreted.

This assessment has been commissioned by Veridia's Chief Executive Officer at the direction of the Chief Security Officer in preparation for the Department of National Defense contract renewal submission due in eight months. The DND contract explicitly requires Veridia to demonstrate ITSG-33 compliance for all systems processing Protected B information under the contract scope.

This document is classified PROTECTED B. It contains detailed descriptions of Veridia's information systems, security architecture, and authorization boundaries. Access is restricted to Veridia personnel with a minimum Secret security clearance and a need-to-know for this assessment.

2. About ITSG-33 and the Security Assessment and Authorization Process

Before examining Veridia and VIPOP specifically, it is important to understand the framework this assessment operates within. ITSG-33 is the Government of Canada's IT security risk management framework published by the Canadian Centre for Cyber Security. It defines how federal departments and their contractors must manage IT security risk across the full lifecycle of information systems -- from initial planning through operation and decommissioning.

2.1 The Three Levels of ITSG-33

ITSG-33 operates across three organizational levels, each with distinct responsibilities. Understanding these levels is an essential context for a federal contractor like Veridia because the framework defines accountability at each level differently.

Level	Name	Primary Responsibilities
Level 1	Organizational	Senior management and executive leadership. Establishes the overall IT security program, defines security objectives and risk tolerance, and provides resources and direction for security activities across the organization. For Veridia this level corresponds to the CEO, CSO, and executive leadership team.
Level 2	Mission and Business Process	Program managers and business owners. Responsible for security categorization of information and systems based on mission requirements, identifying security requirements for business processes, and ensuring that system-level security activities align with organizational objectives. For Veridia, this level corresponds to project managers and contract owners.
Level 3	Information System	System owners, security practitioners, and technical teams. Responsible for selecting, implementing, and assessing security controls for specific information systems. Produces the Security

		Assessment and Authorization package. For Veridia, this level is where the VIPOP assessment is conducted.
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2.2 Security Assessment and Authorization

Security Assessment and Authorization (SA&A) is the formal GoC process by which an information system is evaluated and given official authorization to operate. It is the mechanism through which a system owner demonstrates to an Authorizing Official that the system's security risks are understood that appropriate controls are in place, and that residual risks are acceptable.

The SA&A process for VIPOP consists of the following stages:

- System characterization -- defining what the system is, what it does, and what information it processes (this document)
- Security categorization -- formally assessing the sensitivity of information processed and assigning a categorization level
- Control selection -- identifying the required controls from the ITSG-33 baseline for the assigned categorization
- Control implementation -- implementing the required controls
- Security assessment -- evaluating whether controls are implemented correctly and operating as intended (VS-ITSG-002)
- Security Assessment Report -- documenting assessment findings, residual risks, and an authorization recommendation (VS-ITSG-003)
- Authorization decision -- the Authorizing Official reviews the SAR and makes a formal accept or reject decision

This assessment series covers the security assessment stage of the SA&A process. It assumes that system characterization and categorization are being formalized through this document, and that control selection has been guided by the ITSG-33 Medium baseline defined in Annex 2.

2.3 Why This Matters for Veridia

As a federal IT contractor, Veridia operates in a unique position relative to ITSG-33. Unlike a government department that operates ITSG-33 as an internal governance requirement, Veridia is contractually obligated to demonstrate compliance as a condition of its government contracts. The DND contract renewal requires Veridia to produce documentation demonstrating that VIPOP meets the ITSG-33 Medium baseline for Protected B systems. This assessment series is documentation.

The distinction between voluntary adoption and contractual obligation is significant. ITSG-33 non-compliance for Veridia is not a governance weakness -- it is a contract default condition. A failed renewal submission due to inadequate security documentation would directly affect Veridia's primary revenue stream and its standing as a trusted federal contractor.

3. About Veridia Systems Group Inc.

3.1 Organizational Profile

Legal Name	Veridia Systems Group Inc.
Primary Headquarters	Constitution Square, 350 Albert Street, Ottawa, Ontario, K1R 1A4
Secondary Office	25 Eddy Street, Gatineau, Quebec, J8X 2V7
Year Established	2009
Total Employees	340 full-time equivalents
Technical and Security Staff	85 staff including IT architects, developers, security analysts, and project managers
Facility Security Clearance	Secret -- both Ottawa and Gatineau locations
Personnel Clearances	All technical staff: minimum Secret. Senior staff and project leads: Top Secret
Primary Business Activity	Federal IT professional services, managed services, systems integration, and cybersecurity advisory
Annual Revenue (approximate)	CAD \$52 million

3.2 Active Government Contracts

Veridia holds active contracts with four Government of Canada departments. The security obligations arising from these contracts collectively define the threat of environment within which VIPOP operates and the regulatory requirements this assessment must address.

Client Department	Contract Scope	VIPOP Relevance
Department of National Defense (DND)	IT infrastructure management, cybersecurity advisory services, and security operations support	Primary driver of this assessment. Contract renewal in 8 months requires an ITSG-33 compliance demonstration for all systems processing DND Protected B information including VIPOP.
Public Services and Procurement Canada (PSPC)	Systems integration, custom application development, and IT project management	Project documentation and deliverables stored in VIPOP. Protected B project data processed under this contract.
Treasury Board Secretariat (TBS)	IT managed services and cloud migration advisory	Service delivery tracked through VIPOP. Less sensitive engagement but subject to GoC security baseline requirements.
Health Canada	Application development and maintenance for internal health data systems	Development project documentation stored in VIPOP. Sensitive health program data references in project records.

4. System Description -- VIPOP

4.1 System Overview

The Veridia Integrated Project and Operations Platform (VIPOP) is an internally developed and hosted information system that serves as Veridia's primary platform for managing federal client engagements. VIPOP was developed by Veridia's internal development team and has been in production operations since 2018. It

underwent a significant architecture revision in 2022 to migrate from on-premises hosting to a hybrid Azure Canada East environment.

VIPOP integrates project management, document management, security incident tracking, and client collaboration capabilities into a single platform. It is the system of record for all active GoC client engagements and contains the most sensitive information assets in Veridia's environment.

4.2 System Functions

Function	Description
Project Management	Tracks all active and historical GoC client engagements including project plans, milestones, resource allocations, and deliverable status. All DND, PSPC, TBS, and Health Canada projects are managed through VIOPOP.
Document Management	Stores and manages all project documentation including statements of work, technical designs, system architecture diagrams, security assessment outputs, and client deliverables. Documents are classified and access-controlled by project and clearance level.
Security Incident Tracking	Logs and tracks security incidents, near misses, and security observations across all Veridia projects and internal operations. Contains sensitive information about vulnerabilities and security gaps in both Veridia and client environments.
Client Collaboration Portal	Provides a secure web-based portal through which authorized GoC client personnel can access project status, review deliverables, and communicate with Veridia project teams. Accessible to clear government clients via MFA-protected login.
Personnel and Clearance Management	Tracks security clearance status, clearance expiry dates, and project assignment eligibility for all Veridia personnel. Contains personal information about employees subject to PIPEDA.
Reporting and Analytics	Generates project health reports, security metrics, and compliance status dashboards for Veridia management and for sharing with client departments upon request.

4.3 System Architecture

VIPOP is hosted in a hybrid architecture combining Azure Canada East cloud infrastructure with on-premises components at Veridia's Ottawa headquarters. The architecture was designed to meet the data residency requirements of GoC contracts while providing the scalability and availability benefits of cloud hosting.

Component	Description	Hosting	Data Sensitivity
Web Application Layer	React-based frontend application serving the VIOPOP user interface and client portal	Azure Canada East -- App Service	Handles Confidential and Protected B data in transit
API Gateway and Backend	Node.js API layer handling all business logic, authentication, and data access	Azure Canada East -- Kubernetes Service	Processes Protected B data
Primary Database	PostgreSQL database storing all project, document metadata, incident, and personnel records	Azure Canada East -- Database for PostgreSQL	Contains Protected B and Confidential data at rest

Document Storage	Encrypted blob storage for all project documents and deliverables	Azure Canada East -- Blob Storage with customer-managed keys	Protected B documents
Identity and Access	Azure Active Directory with Conditional Access policies and MFA enforcement	Azure Canada East -- Azure AD	Controls access to all Protected B data
On-Premises Integration Hub	Windows Server 2022 integration server providing connectivity between VIPOP and Veridia's internal network and classified systems	Ottawa HQ -- Server Room	Handles network routing and system integration
Network Security	Azure Firewall, Network Security Groups, and Palo Alto on-premises firewall protecting all VIPOP components	Hybrid -- Azure and On-Premises	Controls traffic to all VIPOP components

4.4 System Users

User Type	Approximate Count	Access Description
Veridia Project Managers	28	Full access to their assigned project workspace including all documents, incident records, and client communications. Read access to other projects within their cleared department.
Veridia Technical Staff	85	Access to technical documentation and deliverables for assigned projects. No access to financial or personnel records. Access controlled by project assignment and clearance level.
Veridia Security Team	12	Access to all security incident records and security assessment outputs. Read access to all project workspaces for security monitoring purposes.
Veridia Management	15	Read access to all project dashboards and reporting. No access to detailed technical documents unless assigned to the project.
GoC Client Personnel	42 (active)	Access to their department's project portal only. View deliverables and project status. Cannot access other departments' data or internal Veridia operational data.
VIPOP System Administrators	4	Full administrative access to all VIPOP components. Access is privileged and subject to enhanced monitoring and PAM controls.

5. Security Categorization

Security categorization is the foundational step in the ITSG-33 SA&A process. It determines the sensitivity of the information processed by VIPOP and the potential injury that would result from a compromise of that

information's confidentiality, integrity, or availability. The categorization result drives the selection of required security controls from the ITSG-33 control catalogue.

Categorization follows the methodology defined in ITSG-06 -- Harmonized Threat and Risk Assessment Methodology and the information categorization guidance in ITSG-33 Annex 1. The three security objectives -- confidentiality, integrity, and availability -- are assessed independently.

5.1 Information Types Processed by VIPOP

The following information types are processed, stored, or transmitted by VIPOP. Each information type contributes to the overall system of categorization based on the potential injury level associated with its compromise.

Information Type	GoC Classification	Description and Sensitivity Rationale
GoC Client Project Documentation	Protected B	Technical designs, system architectures, security assessment outputs, and project deliverables for DND, PSPC, TBS, and Health Canada engagements. Unauthorized disclosure could reveal sensitive government program information, system vulnerabilities, or operational security details.
Security Incident Records	Protected B	Records of security incidents, near misses, and vulnerabilities identified across Veridia for projects and operations. Disclosure could enable adversaries to exploit known weaknesses in government-supporting systems.
Personnel Security Clearance Data	Protected B	Security clearance levels, clearance expiry dates, and personnel vetting information for Veridia staff. Personal information subject to PIPEDA and GoC personnel security requirements.
Client Collaboration Communications	Protected B	Communications between Veridia project teams and GoC client personnel including technical discussions, issue logs, and approval records.
Project Financial and Commercial Data	Confidential	Contract values, billing records, and commercial terms for GoC engagements. Commercially sensitive but not classified at Protected B.
Internal Operational Records	Confidential	Internal project management data, resource allocations, and operational metrics. Sensitive commercially but not at a level requiring Protected B handling.
Published Deliverables and Reports	Unclassified	Finalized deliverables are approved for client distribution. Not sensitive once released to the authorized client.

5.2 Categorization Assessment

Each security objective is assessed based on the potential injury to Canada or to individuals that would result from unauthorized compromise. ITSG-33 uses three injury levels: Low (limited adverse effect), Medium (serious adverse effect), and High (severe or catastrophic adverse effect).

Security Objective	Category	Rationale
Confidentiality	MEDIUM	VIPOP processes Protected B government information including security incident records, client system architectures, and personnel

		security clearance data. Unauthorized disclosure of this information could cause serious injury to GoC programs, national security interests, or individual privacy. Protected B is defined by the GoC as information whose unauthorized disclosure could reasonably be expected to cause serious injury to national interest, organizational interests, or personal privacy. Medium categorization is the appropriate level for systems whose primary data type is Protected B.
Integrity	MEDIUM	The integrity of information in VIPOP is critical to Veridia's ability to deliver accurate and reliable services to GoC clients. Unauthorized modification of project documentation, security assessment records, or client deliverables could materially affect government program delivery, corrupt security records used for incident response or result in incorrect deliverables being submitted to client departments. The consequences of integrity failure are serious and could directly affect the safety and effectiveness of government operations.
Availability	LOW	While VIPOP availability is important to Veridia's operational efficiency, short-term unavailability would not prevent GoC clients from fulfilling their critical missions. Client departments maintain their own systems and can continue operating without access to the Veridia project portal for limited periods. Extended outages of more than 48 hours would begin to affect contract delivery obligations but would not constitute a national security risk. Low availability categorization reflects the portal nature of the system rather than a mission-critical dependency.

5.3 Formal System Categorization Statement

FORMAL CATEGORIZATION STATEMENT

The Veridia Integrated Project and Operations Platform (VIPOP) is formally categorized as follows in accordance with ITSG-33 and ITSG-06:

Confidentiality: MEDIUM | Integrity: MEDIUM | Availability: LOW

Overall System Categorization: MEDIUM

This categorization result requires application of the ITSG-33 Medium baseline control set as defined in Annex 2. All controls in the Medium baseline are required for VIPOP unless a documented exclusion with risk acceptance has been approved by the Authorizing Official.

6. Authorization Boundary

The authorization boundary defines the perimeter of the ITSG-33 assessment -- everything inside the boundary is subject to the control requirements, and everything outside is explicitly excluded. Defining a precise authorization boundary is one of the most important steps in the SA&A process because it determines accountability for security controls.

The VIPOP authorization boundary encompasses all components, data flows, interfaces, and personnel involved in the processing, storage, or transmission of VIPOP information. It does not include the underlying infrastructure

operated by Microsoft Azure, which falls under Microsoft's own security program and is addressed through the third-party risk management controls in the assessment.

6.1 Components Within the Authorization Boundary

- All VIPOP application components hosted in Azure Canada East including the web application layer, API gateway, backend services, and microservices
- The primary PostgreSQL database and all VIPOP-managed data stores in Azure
- The Azure Blob Storage environment used for document storage under Veridia's tenant
- The Azure Active Directory tenant used for VIPOP identity and access management
- The on-premises integration hub at Ottawa HQ including its operating system, network interfaces, and integration software
- The network security controls protecting VIPOP including Azure Firewall, Network Security Groups, and the Palo Alto on-premises firewall segments dedicated to VIPOP traffic
- All Veridia personnel with access to VIPOP including administrators, users, and security team members
- All VIPOP source code, build pipelines, and deployment processes in Azure DevOps

6.2 Components Outside the Authorization Boundary

Excluded Component	Justification and Risk Management Approach
Microsoft Azure physical infrastructure and hypervisor layer	Microsoft operates the underlying Azure infrastructure under its own security program. Veridia relies on Microsoft's FedRAMP High authorization and Canadian data residency guarantees. Third-party risk controls in the VIPOP assessment address the monitoring of this provider's relationship.
GoC client systems and networks	Client departments operate their own ITSG-33 programs covering their internal systems. The interface between client systems and the VIPOP client portal is addressed through the System and Communications Protection controls within the boundary.
Veridia corporate IT systems not connected to VIPOP	General office productivity systems, HR systems, and financial systems that have no network connectivity to VIPOP are excluded. These systems are addressed under Veridia's broader organizational security program.
Personal devices of Veridia personnel not enrolled in MDM	Personal devices not enrolled in Veridia's Mobile Device Management system are prohibited from accessing VIPOP by Conditional Access policy. Any personal device that attempts to connect and is denied is outside the authorization boundary.

7. Assessment Scope and Methodology

7.1 Control Baseline

The ITSG-33 Medium baseline from Annex 2 defines the required controls for VIPOP based on its Medium categorization. The baseline is organized across the 18 ITSG-33 control families. Each control in the baseline is assessed in the Gap Analysis Spreadsheet (VS-ITSG-002) for its implementation status at Veridia.

The 18 control families assessed are:

ID	Control Family	ID	Control Family
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AC	Access Control	IR	Incident Response
AT	Awareness and Training	MA	Maintenance
AU	Audit and Accountability	MP	Media Protection
CA	Security Assessment and Authorization	PE	Physical and Environmental Protection
CM	Configuration Management	PL	Planning
CP	Contingency Planning	PS	Personnel Security
IA	Identification and Authentication	RA	Risk Assessment
SA	System and Services Acquisition	SC	System and Communications Protection
SI	System and Information Integrity	PM	Program Management

7.2 Implementation Status Definitions

Each control in the Gap Analysis Spreadsheet is assessed using the following four implementation status categories. These definitions are consistent with ITSG-33 assessment guidance and with the terminology used in GoC Security Assessment Reports.

Status	Definition
Implemented	The control is fully in place, operating as intended, and evidence of implementation is available. The control satisfies the ITSG-33 requirement without qualification.
Partially Implemented	The control exists and provides some protection but has identifiable gaps in coverage, documentation, testing, or effectiveness. The control does not fully satisfy the ITSG-33 requirement in its current state.
Not Implemented	The control is not in place. The requirement is not met, and the associated security risk is unmitigated. Remediation is required.
Not Applicable	The control requirement does not apply to VIPOP given its architecture, hosting environment, or operational context. A documented justification must accompany any Not Applicable Determination and must be approved by the Authorizing Official.

7.3 Gap Severity Rating

Gaps identified for Partially Implemented and Not Implemented controls are rated using the following severity scale. Severity reflects the risk to VIPOP and to the GoC information it processes arising from the control gap, considering both the likelihood of exploitation and the potential impact.

Severity	Criteria	Required Action
Critical	Control is not implemented at all. The gap represents a fundamental failure to protect Protected B information. Exploitation of this gap would likely result in serious injury consistent with the Medium categorization.	Immediate remediation is required. Escalate to CSO and CEO within 24 hours. Remediation plan approved within 5 business days. Report to DND contract security officer.

High	Control is substantially not implemented or only nominally in place without effectiveness. Serious risk to confidentiality, integrity, or availability of Protected B information exists.	Formal remediation plan with named owner and timeline within 30 days. Monthly progress reporting to CSO.
Medium	Control is partially implemented. The core protection exists, but gaps in coverage, documentation, or testing reduce its effectiveness below the ITSG-33 requirement.	Remediation plan within 60 days. Reported in quarterly security posture review.
Low	Control is substantially implemented with minor gaps that represent marginal risk reduction opportunities rather than material security failures.	Address through continuous improvement. Noted in the Security Assessment Report as an observation.

8. Assessment Deliverables

Document ID	Title	Purpose and Audience
VS-ITSG-001	System Characterization and Assessment Scope (this document)	Establishes organizational context, system description, authorization boundary, security categorization, and assessment methodology. Required reading before the Gap Analysis or SAR. Audience: all readers of this assessment series.
VS-ITSG-002	ITSG-33 Gap Analysis Spreadsheet	Control-by-control assessment of VIPOP against the ITSG-33 Medium baseline across all 18 control families. Implementation status, gap descriptions, severity ratings, and remediation actions. Audience: CSO, security team, system owner, and internal audit.
VS-ITSG-003	Security Assessment Report	Formal GoC-style SAR documenting assessment findings, residual risk by control family, overall risk posture, and an authorization recommendation to the Authorizing Official. Produced to support the DND contract renewal submission. Audience: CEO, CSO, Authorizing Official, and DND contract security officer.

9. Authorizing Official and Roles

The SA&A process requires a named Authorizing Official who reviews the Security Assessment Report and makes the formal authorization decision. For VIPOP, the following roles are designated.

Role	Assigned To	SA&A Responsibilities
Authorizing Official	Chief Executive Officer	Reviews the Security Assessment Report, evaluates residual risk, and makes the formal authorization decision to operate VIPOP. Accountable to GoC clients for the security of information processed by VIPOP.

System Owner	Chief Security Officer	Owns the SA&A process for VIPOP. Reviews all assessment deliverables. Approves the Gap Analysis findings. Formally accepts or rejects the authorization recommendation. Primary point of contact for DND contract security officer.
Security Assessment Lead	Ashkon Irani	Conducts the security assessment, produces all three deliverables, identifies gaps and remediation actions, and presents findings to the System Owner and Authorizing Official.
VIPOP System Administrator	IT Director	Provides technical evidence of control implementation, facilitates access to system configurations and logs, and implements remediation actions as directed by the System Owner.
Information System Security Officer	Senior Security Analyst	Supports ongoing monitoring of VIPOP security controls following authorization. Maintains the authorization package and triggers reassessment when significant changes occur.

10. Document Review and Approval

This document is reviewed by the Chief Security Officer and approved by the Chief Executive Officer before the assessment series proceeds. Changes to the authorization boundary, system categorization, or assessment scope require re-approval before the Gap Analysis findings are finalized.

Role	Name	Signature	Date
Prepared By (Assessment Lead)	Ashkon Irani	[Signed]	05/21/2026
Reviewed By (System Owner)	Chief Security Officer	[Signed]	05/21/2026
Approved By (Auth. Official)	Chief Executive Officer	[Signed]	05/21/2026

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